

Formal Letter

A letter is a written message sent from one person to another. Letters can be formal or informal depending on the relationship between the writer and the receiver.

A formal letter is written to people in official positions or to people we do not know personally.

Examples include letters written to:

The principal

A company manager

A government official

An editor of a newspaper

Definition of Formal Letter

A formal letter is an official letter written to someone in authority or for official purposes using polite and formal language.

Features of a Formal Letter

A formal letter has the following parts:

1. Writer's Address

This is the address of the person writing the letter.

Example:

15 Unity Street

Wuse Zone 3

Abuja

2. Date

This is written below the writer's address.

Example:

10th March, 2026

3. Receiver's Address

This is the address of the person receiving the letter.



Example:

The Principal

Government Secondary School

Garki, Abuja

4. Salutation

This is the greeting used in the letter.

Examples:

Dear Sir,

Dear Madam,

5. Heading / Title

This shows the purpose of the letter.

Example:

Application for Permission to Organize a Debate

6. Body of the Letter

This contains the main message.

It is usually written in paragraphs.

Introduction paragraph

Main explanation

Conclusion

7. Complimentary Close

This is the polite way to end the letter.

Examples:

Yours faithfully

Yours sincerely

8. Signature and Name



The writer signs and writes their name.

Example:

Yours faithfully

(Signature)

Victory Ojeba

Characteristics of Formal Letters

Use formal language.

Avoid slang and contractions.

Be clear and direct.

Be polite and respectful.

Follow the correct format.

Example of a Formal Letter

15 Unity Street,
Wuse Zone 3,
Abuja.
10th March, 2026

The Principal,

Government Secondary School

Garki, Abuja

Dear Sir,

APPLICATION FOR PERMISSION TO ORGANIZE A DEBATE

I write to request permission to organize a debate competition in our school. The purpose of the debate is to improve students' speaking skills and build their confidence.

The debate will involve students from different classes and will take place in the school hall next month. We believe this activity will help students develop their communication abilities and critical thinking.

I will be grateful if my request is granted.



Yours faithfully,

(Signature)

Gambo Salami.

